However, data governance does not stop at pointing fingers. Instead, it helps data owners become or stay compliant with internal and external regulations by doing the following:

- Clearly stating the demands imposed by regulations such as the GDPR, California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA), or HIPAA
- Providing frameworks enabling meeting these demands

The difference between people doing what they might and data governance offering a coherent way of addressing all questions related to data oversight may equal tens of millions of dollars saved.

Yet again, as a process, data governance is not about creating a glossary of terms or a repository of regulations. Instead, it's supposed to evolve its policies, add codes of conduct, and review best practices. We hope we managed to convince you that data governance is all of the following:

- An essential element of increasing business value derived from data (or preventing the losses), by enforcing transparency of data assets' contents
- A way to maximize usability of data assets, by developing clearly defined roles of responsibility and accountability for data, as well as ensuring that data assets and their access points are mapped and available to data users
- Critical for control over data assets and compliance with internal and external regulations, by having the authority and access to expertise allowing development of actionable policies

To achieve all that, you need to take these steps:

1. Define the deliverables you expect from your data governance bodies.
2. Decide how you will distribute responsibilities and accountability for various governance aspects.
3. Ensure that your governance protocols don't introduce bottlenecks and that the administrative overhead won't slow development.